

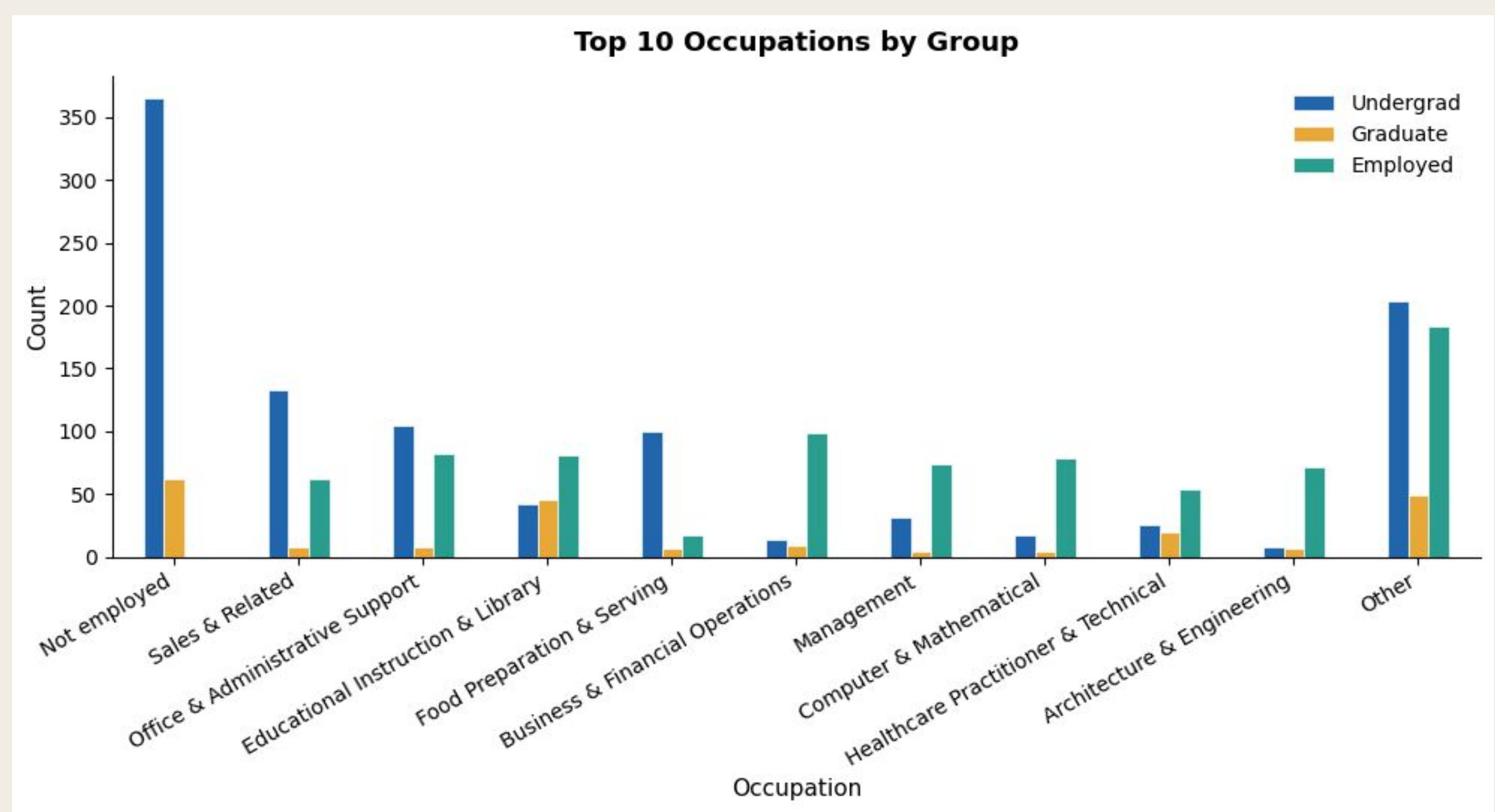
What distinguishes the ways undergrads, graduate students, and employed new-grads spend their time?

Alisha Li – Spring 2026 Data Science Capstone

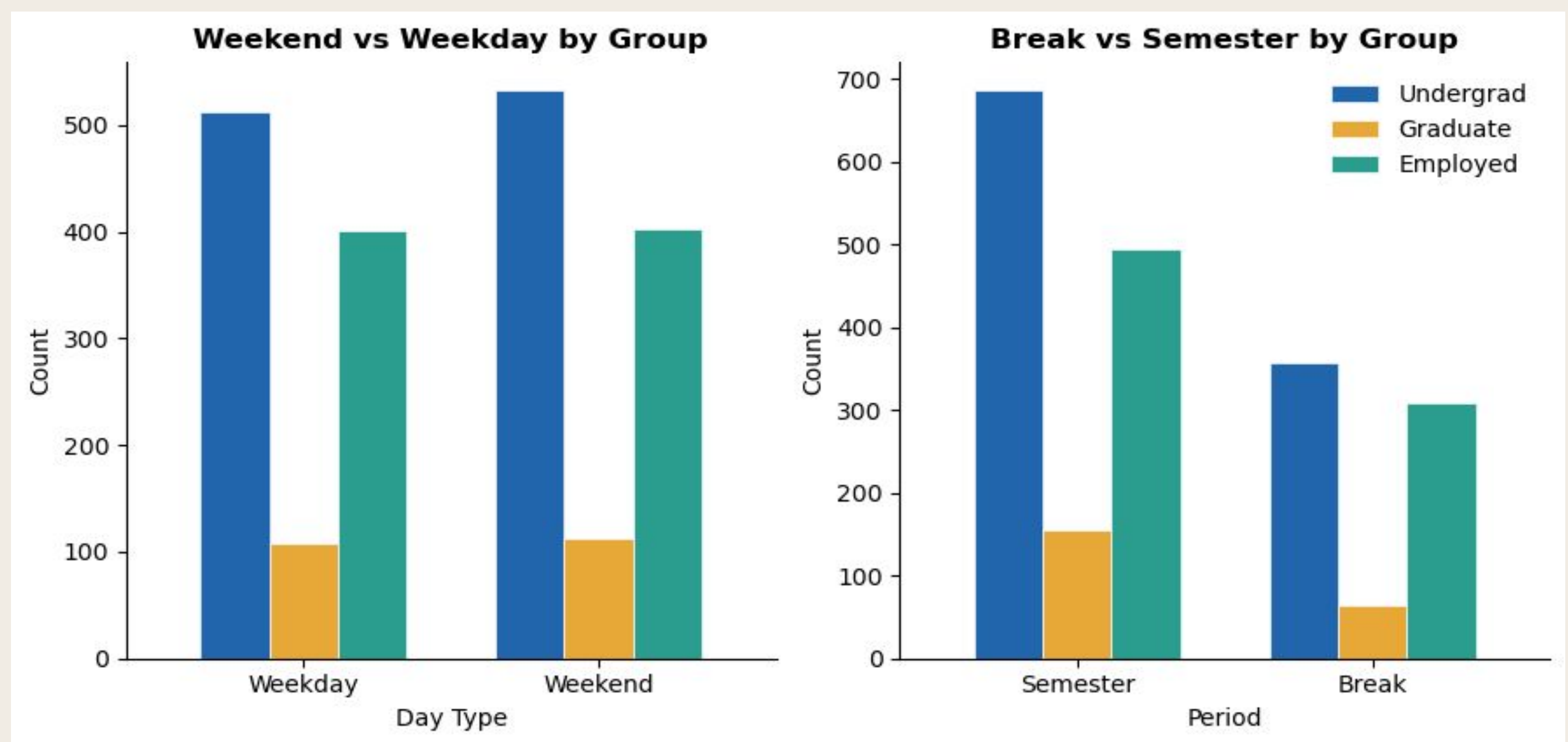
Background & Motivation

Lifestyle is a key factor in undergrads’ decisions on what to pursue after college. While prior research primarily examines one group at a time, little work has been done comparing between them. This study aims to see if there are broad differences across educated young adults which may prompt future investigations.

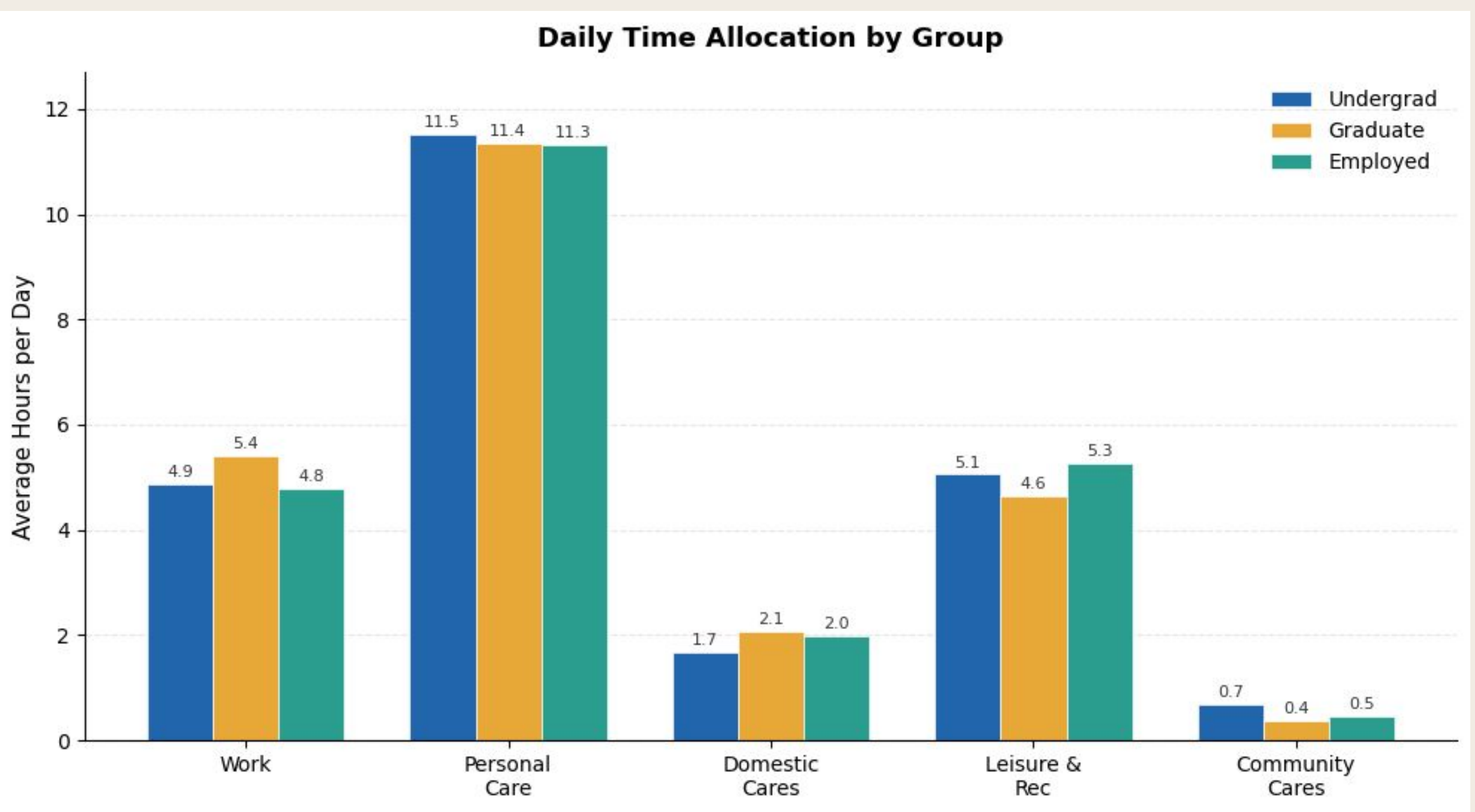
About the data



- ### American Time Use Survey
- Participants recall how their spent their prior day from 4am to 4am
 - 2015-19, 2023-24
 - Ages 19-26
- ### Final Dataset
- 2067 respondents
 - 1044 Undergrad (no bachelors, enrolled),
 - 803 Employed New-Grad (bachelors, not enrolled, employed)
 - 220 Graduate (bachelors, enrolled)
 - 3 background variables: sex, year, weekend, break
 - 6 activity buckets: work, personal care, domestic cares, leisure/rec, community cares, NA

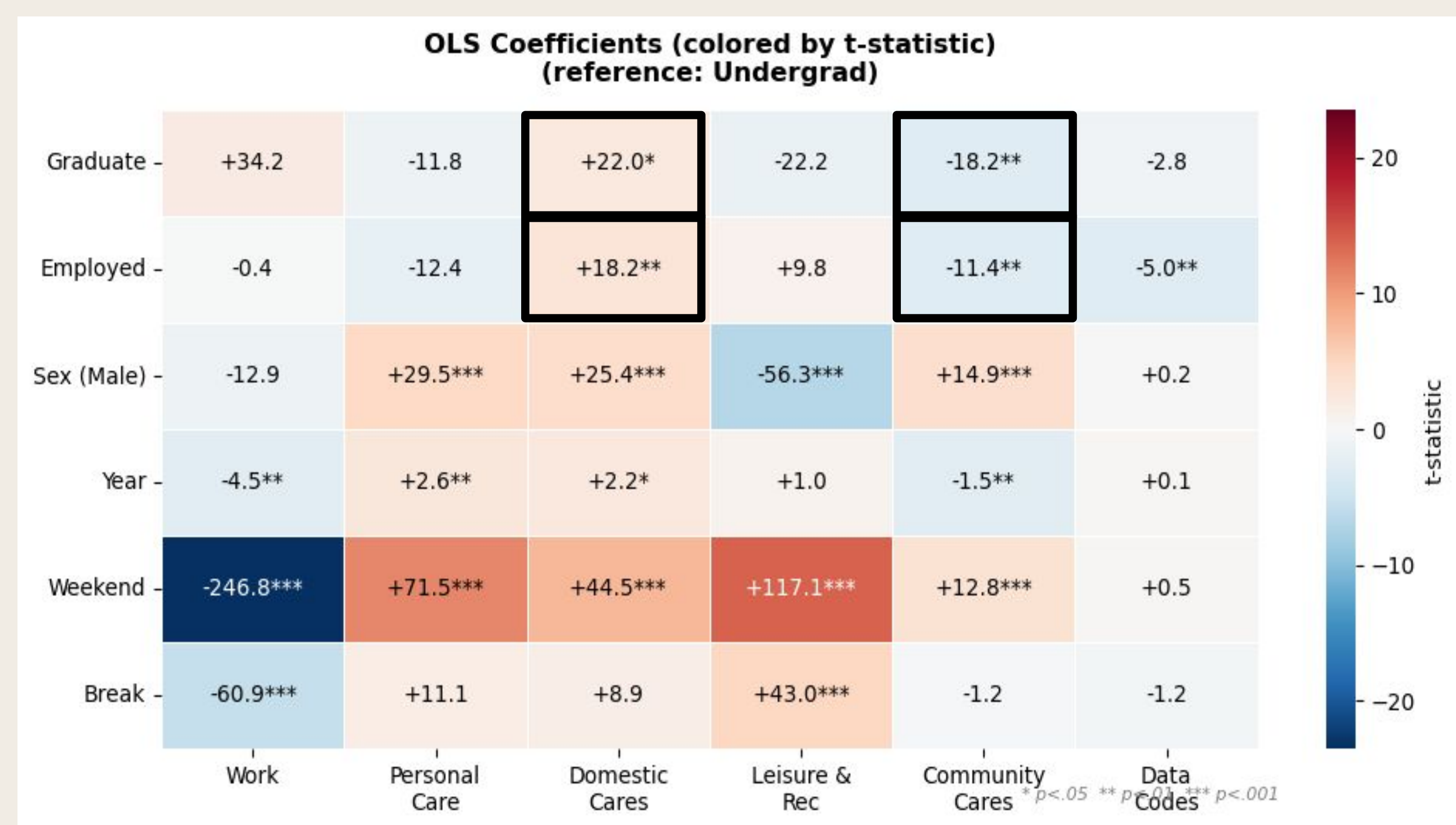


Exploratory Data Analysis

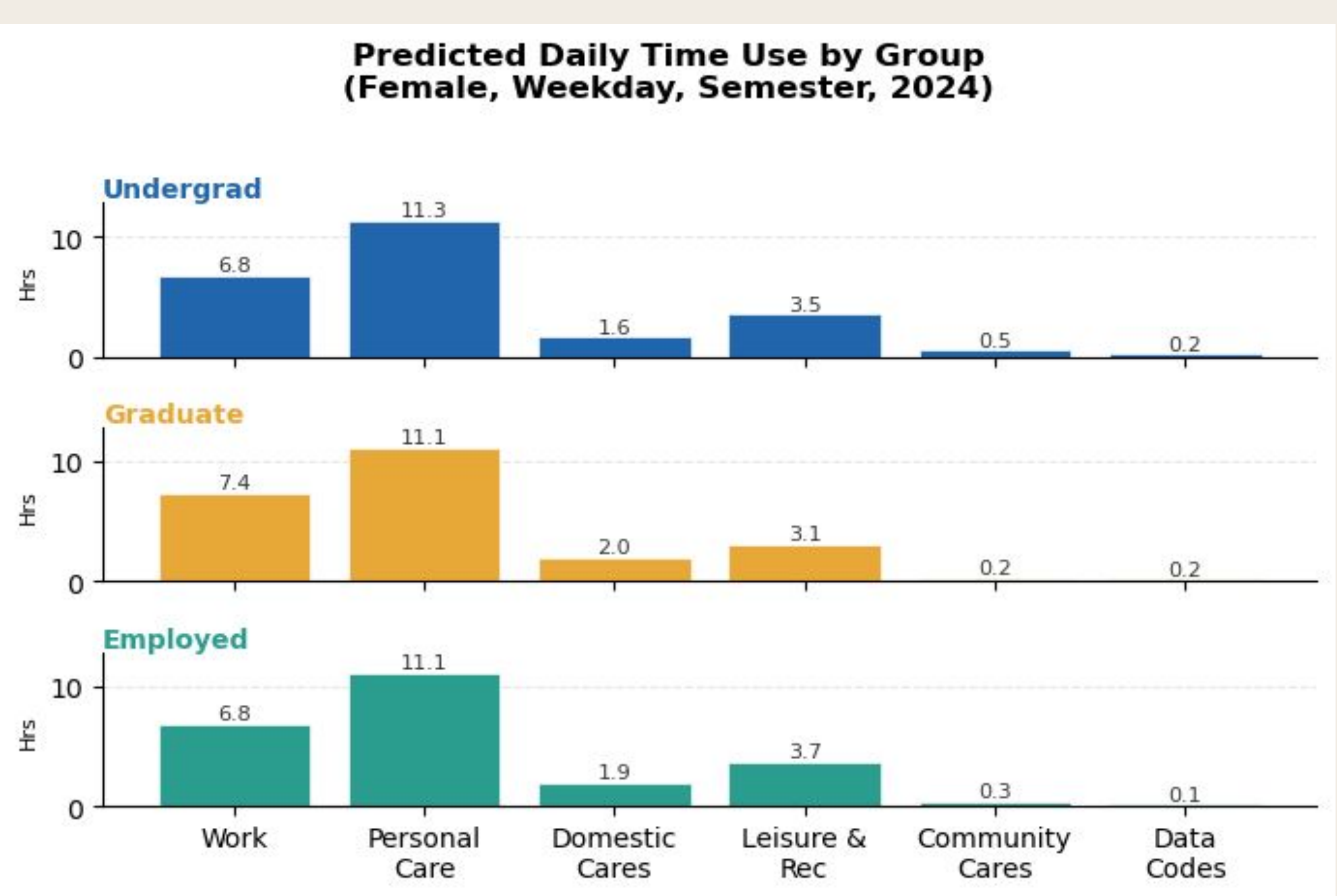
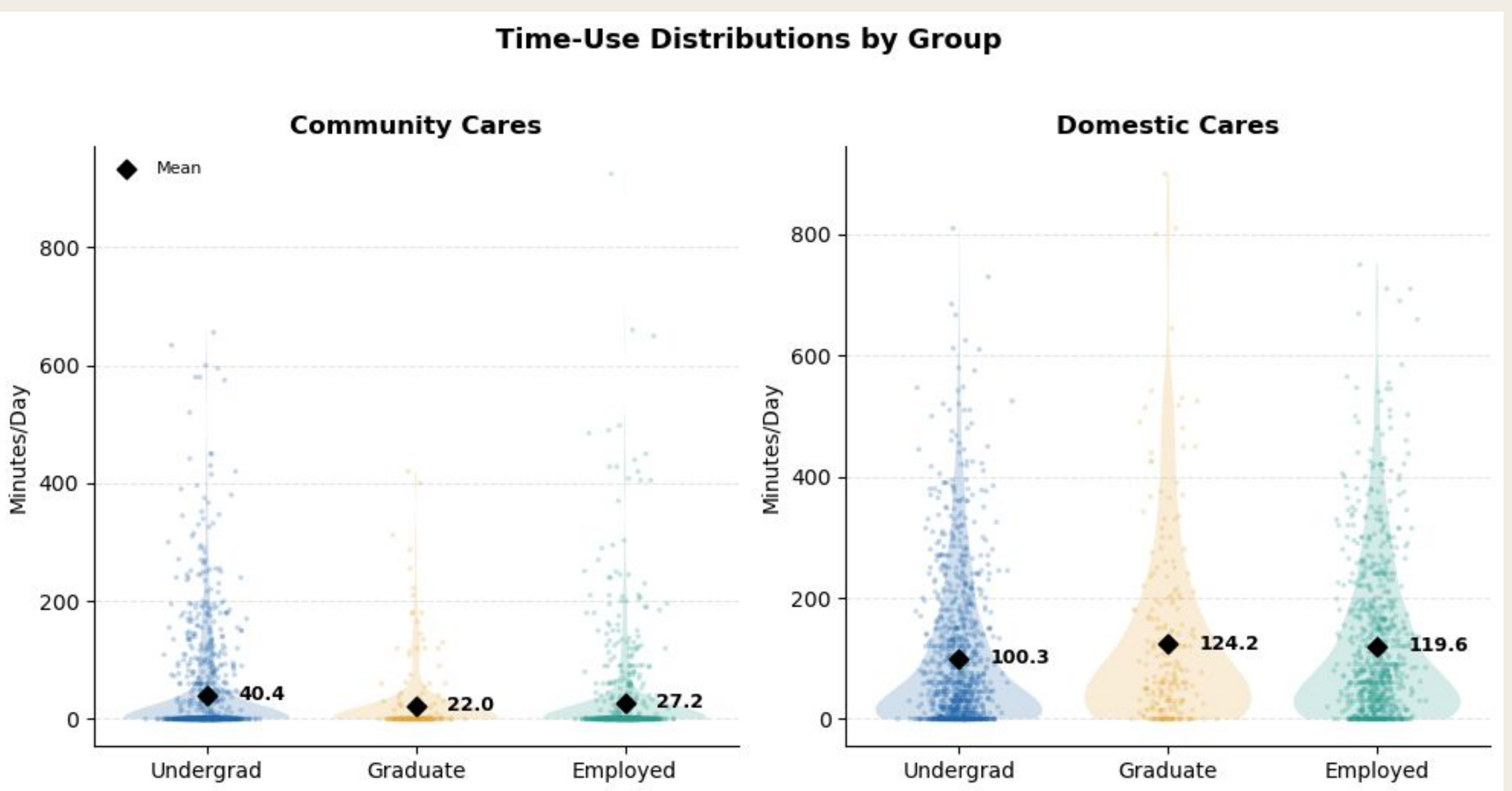


Methodology

- Multinomial logistic regressions of group on background vs group on background + activities
 - Likelihood Ratio Test showed adding activities do improve group prediction
- | Model | Log-Likelihood | AIC |
|-----------------|----------------|---------|
| Background only | -1945.46 | 3910.92 |
| With Activites | -1922.06 | 3888.12 |
- p-value < .01
- Final Model:** Linear regressions of activities on group + background



Results & Conclusions



- ### Group membership matters most for domestic and community cares.
- Community care: 18min less – grad, 11min less – employ
 - Domestic care: 22min more – grad, 18min more – employ
- ### Limitations:
- Time tracking accuracy from recollection is questionable
 - Does not consider different academia fields
 - R² was low across all activities (.0046-.2239)
- ### Future Work:
- Building better time tracking systems
 - Investigating differences between fields (i.e. are medical students the one dragging leisure & rec down?)
 - Consider logistic regression for predicting 0 minutes before linear

Acknowledgements: Thanks to Professor Pattanayak and students in the spring 2026 DS Capstone Course for feedback throughout the semester.
References: 1. Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor. American Time Use Survey, 2015–2019, 2023–2024. <https://www.bls.gov/tus/>